

- ✓ The creditor's phone number
- ✓ Your account number with that creditor
- ✓ The date the account was opened
- ✓ The type of account (auto, mortgage, etc.; credit cards = "revolving")
- ✓ The credit limit/original amount
- ✓ Reported since (date account started being reported)
- ✓ Terms (length of the mortgage; if a credit card, NA for Not Applicable)
- ✓ Monthly payment (credit cards may show \$0)
- ✓ High balance (highest balance to date or original loan amount)
- ✓ Recent balance
- ✓ Status/remark (Open/Current; Paid/Closed; Never Late; etc. Open/Current = good standing)
- ✓ Date of status (date that the Status section was last updated)
- ✓ Last reported (date creditor last reported any information)
- ✓ Responsibility (joint or individual account; spouse's name may be listed)
- ✓ Recent payment (last payment received)
- ✓ Account history (sometimes the balance history just lists a lot of zeros)

Check, Check, Double Check

If you have a lot of financial activity, your credit report can be quite lengthy. If you do not have your own credit reports to look at right now while we are talking about this stuff, get a sample report to use as a guide. You can view one at the websites of the credit reporting agencies.

First, the easy part. Check your personal information: your name, your middle initial, etc. If you come across any mistakes in this section – and you might – notify that credit reporting agency directly.

You would be amazed how often someone else's information turns up on your credit report, simply for having the same name as you, the